

This week's פרשה has the great פגישה, the great confrontation, between יהודה and יוסף. יוסף has threatened to imprison בנימין because he accused him of stealing the גביע. יהודה comes to בנימין's defense, delivering an impassioned speech. Following this, יוסף reveals himself with the famous words (45:3), אֲנִי יוֹסֵף הָעוֹד אָבִי. The תורה tells us, וְלֹא יָכְלוּ אֶחָיו לַעֲנוֹת אוֹתוֹ כִּי נִבְהָלוּ מִפָּנָיו. The brothers were astonished and overcome with fear. It was both shocking and terrifying for them to discover that this אדון מצרים who had been challenging them, was יוסף. The בית הליי brings several profound questions on this episode:

1. All of יהודה's טענות centered on sparing יעקב from the immense pain of losing בנימין. יהודה argued that their actions were only for the sake of their father. If so, why does יוסף suddenly ask, **הָאֲנִי יוֹסֵף הָעוֹד אֲבִי הִי**? Where is the place for this question? It seems unnecessary and irrelevant.
2. When the brothers returned to מצרים the second time, יוסף already asked them (43:27), **הַשְׁלוֹם אֲבִיכֶם הַזֶּה**? They had not yet returned to ארץ ישראל but were caught on the way and brought back. Why would יוסף ask again, **הָעוֹד אֲבִי הִי**?
3. Even if the question was valid, where is the answer? The תורה does not record any response from the brothers.

אי לנו מיום said: אָפּאָ פֿהן פֿרֿדלעך - אָפּאָ פֿהן פֿרֿדלעך אָמר: (מדרש רבה 93:10) פסוק brought on this מדרש There's a הדין - woe to us from the day of the day of judgment, which will be at משיח's time, or after a person's 120 years; יוסף - יוסף קטנן של שבטים - from the day of reproach; אי לנו מיום התוכחה the youngest of the שבטים, (of course, except for בנימין); they couldn't - ולא יכלו אָחיו לענות אתו כי נבְּהִלּוּ מִפְּנֵיו (בנימין); answer him because they were so astonished; when - לְכַשְׁיבּוֹא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּרוּךְ הוּא וַיּוֹכִיחַ כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד לְפִי מַה שֶּׁהוּא; אוכיח: (תהלים נ, כא) מוסר, his תוכחה, his reproof, as the פסוק says the הקב"ה comes and gives each one his מוסר, his תוכחה, his reproof, as the פסוק says מדרש: Where is the תוכחה in this פסוק? It seems like יוסף was simply revealing his identity, not delivering תוכחה. Moreover, what is the distinction between תוכחה and דין?

To understand this, we must see יוסף's question הֲיִנְעוֹד אֲפִי not as a query, but as a rhetorical statement. It was not a פְּיוֹס, an attempt to appease them, but rather a sharp תוכחה. After יוסף revealed himself, he initially refrained from using any לשון of אחוה or אהבה, saying only אֲנִי יוֹסֵף, without referring to them as brothers. Only after the second פסוק, after it says, כִּי נִבְהָלוּ מִפָּנָיו, does it say (45:4), אֲנִי יוֹסֵף אֲחֵיכֶם, with a לשון of אחוה, showing that he really loves them and considers them his brothers. But in the first פסוק it just mentions אֲנִי יוֹסֵף, without any אחוה or אהבה. יוסף's rhetorical question was, "You just finished telling me how much you care about our father. If you were so concerned about his suffering, why did you not think of that when you sold me?" This was a powerful accusation against them. יוסף essentially told them, "If my father could live after you sold me, losing בנימין can't be anywhere near as bad as that." This סתירה undermined every טענה יהודה had just made.

This is the meaning of **יום התוכחה** and **יום הדין**. You claim to be so busy you have no time for a seder in torah, but you have time to read a newspaper or watch a show. The **דין** is what we did or did not do. The **תוכחה** is the scrutiny of our rationalizations.

I want to wish everybody a good Shabbos, and Im Yirtzeh Hashem, we should hear גיטא בשורות, and you should all have נחת from the family, we should have נחת from you, and we should all be געזונט and שטארק, and we should continue to meet by שמחות.

